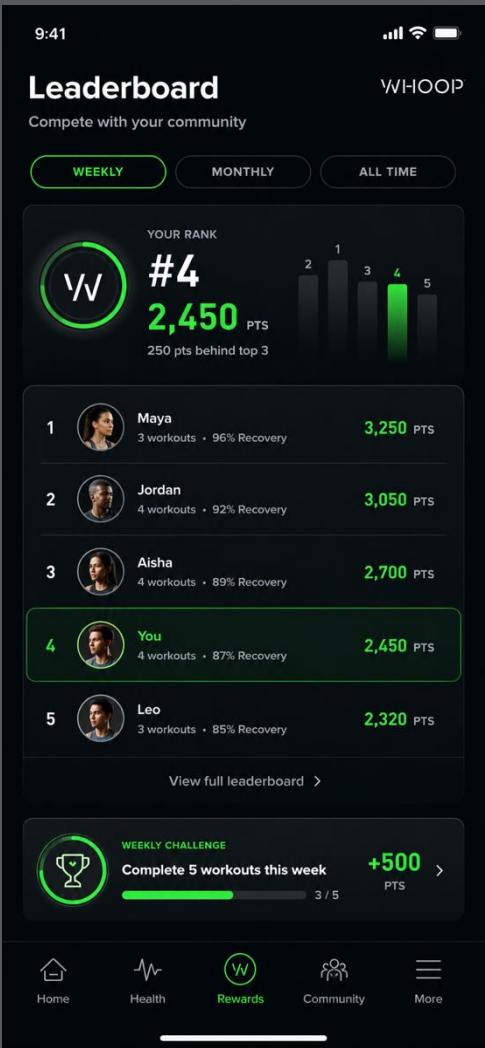




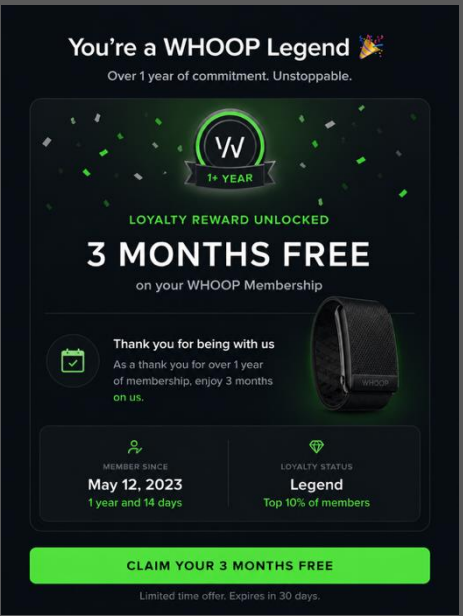
TASK A

The inclusion of a leaderboard and community-based challenges adds a social and competitive element to the WHOOP platform. This encourages users to remain active within the application while motivating self improvement through competition and accountability. Having a competitive leaderboard can influence users in competing with their friends and family. Naturally, customer word of mouth can then be used to reach other potential users who want to join a community of people focused on self improvement.

The personalised rewards section gives users clear and achievable goals to work towards, helping improve motivation and user retention. Customers can earn points through behaviours such as maintaining recovery streaks and improving sleep consistency. These points can then be redeemed for WHOOP products such as personalised bands and replacement batteries. These products range between £40-£60 which can be viewed as a valuable trade off for the user. From WHOOP’s perspective, the ROI on retaining a user for another annual subscription for an accessory for a fraction of the price returns a higher value than to lose a user.



The WHOOP rewards interface has been designed to increase long term customer engagement and retention by giving users something to consistently work towards. Rather than only tracking fitness and recovery data, the rewards system introduces a points-based progression model that rewards positive behaviour and consistent use of the platform. This helps create a stronger relationship between the customer and the WHOOP brand, increasing the perceived value of the subscription. WHOOP have cemented themselves in the self-improvement market, being an attractive option for people who want to become the best versions of themselves. There is a form of emotional connection with the brand; having a reward system integrated into this product can be a motivating factor to continue positive habits as the user has a visual progress monitor for rewards.



Users who consistently renew their WHOOP membership are rewarded with free membership periods. This creates a stronger incentive to continue subscribing to WHOOP over a longer period of time and reduces customer churn. A big pain point for WHOOP has always been to justify their high subscription model as they are one of the only products in the wearable market who uses this model. Products such as the Apple Watch and Garmin watches are a one time purchase for the device. Implementing this feature of rewarding the customer for loyalty can help in areas of reducing cancellations and making the user feel more valued.

TASK B

Introduction - Reference to Problem Statement

WHOOP uses a tiered subscription model with three pricing levels (£169, £229, £349 per year). This gives customers options, but it also means they expect clear value at each level. At the start, the data and insights feel useful and engaging, but over time they can become repetitive. Users start to feel like they’ve already learned what they need, so the value of continuing the subscription becomes less clear. From a CRM perspective, this shows a drop in perceived value, which directly affects retention. When customers feel like the cost is higher than the benefit, they disengage and eventually cancel. This leads to higher churn, lower customer lifetime value, and weaker long-term relationships. With one third of users not using their devices within 6 months (Chang, W, 2026) the following points are crucial to ensure that WHOOP creates a system that can retain customers but can continue to onboard new ones.

Gamification for Community Engagement

WHOOP has succeeded in gamifying the use of data analysis and making it very easy for the average person to review their data in regard to their health. However, overtime reviewing your data on days that your body may not be operating at it’s best can affect a user's mental health. According to Joseph Welstead, waking up to different recovery scores affected his self confidence. Having a red score next to your recovery can easily set the tone for the day (Welstead, J,2020). Having a more positive gamified experience in relation to community engagement and rewards can improve motivation and overall engagement off the product and application. The research found via (Del-Valle-Soto,2024) shows that gamifying a hard task can make the behaviour change process more enjoyable and increases the adherence to achieve goals.

Personalisation

For the personalisation element of the reward system, incentives such as points, rewards, levels, and badges are common for i ncreasing the motivation and usage of a system, making physical activities or exercise more fun and enhancing users’ persistence. (Chang, W, 2026) Having rewards that can enhance the physic al product can contribute to the emotional relationship the user has to the brand; having a specific band based on high level fitness can act as a statement piece to other users which can not only motivate the user who wears this accessory but also motivate users who are climbing up the rewards chart. Personalisation can also neatly tie into outreach via social media. Posts, tags and hashtags can be used to promote the achievement of attaining the rewards.

Customer Retention and Loyalty

Long Term user engagement is one of the main challenges that WHOOP’s faces with having a subscription-based model which has been an unmet requirement that has stemmed from overlooking engagement-enabling benefits (Del-Valle-Soto, 2024). Users can easily switch to a competitor that uses a one time purchase model and can very easily receive similar benefits to WHOOP, removing the need to have a recurring subscription. Including the incentive of rewarding a user based on the length of their subscription can enable a user to feel they are being valued which significantly influence users’ device loyalty and continuance exercise intentions (Chang, W, 2026).

Conclusion

Overall, the WHOOP rewards programme has been designed to improve long-term customer engagement and retention by giving users more value beyond just the wearable and health data itself. By rewarding users for consistently renewing their subscriptions and engaging with the platform, the programme helps create a stronger relationship between the customer and the brand. Features such as personalised rewards and progression systems with community interaction help keep users motivated while making the subscription feel more worthwhile over a longer period of time. This directly addresses the issue identified in Task 3, where users may begin to struggle justifying the ongoing sub scription cost once the data and insights start to feel repetitive.

References

Del-Valle-Soto, C., López-Pimentel, J.C., Vázquez-Castillo, J., Nolzco-Flores, J.A., Velázquez, R., Varela-Aldás, J. and Visconti, P. (2024) ‘A comprehensive review of behavior change techniques in wearables and IoT: Implications for health and well-being’, *Sensors*, 24(8), p. 2429. Available at: <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11054424/>

Chang, W., Huang, Y. and Kim, D. (2026) *The influence of gamification features in wearable fitness devices on perceived value, device loyalty, and exercise continuance intention: the moderating role of personal innovativeness*. Humanities and Social Sciences Communications, 13(316). Available at: <https://www.nature.com/articles/s41599-026-06640-2>

Welstead J (2020) 5 Reasons I ditched my Whoop Band. Available at: <https://motionnutrition.com/blogs/sleep/5-reasons-i-ditched-my-whoop-band>